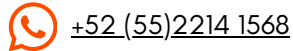


Eduardo Castro

Marketing Director | Brand Building, Innovation & Commercial Leadership | FMCG & CPG



SUMMARY

Engineer by training, marketer by conviction. **13+ years** building brand systems and innovation pipelines that produce measurable revenue growth across **LATAM** and the **US**, from national scope at **PepsiCo** to **13-country** regional ownership at **J&J** to US venture incubation at **Grupo Mariposa**. Full accountability for **teams of up to 10**, budgets exceeding **US\$2.2M**, and board-level investment defense. Dual recipient of "James E. Burke" and "Circle of Champions", top-tier **corporate awards**.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

apex Consulting - Marketing Leader.

Mar 2024 - Current

Advertising Services | Mexico City, Mexico

- Lead commercial strategy and recommendation architecture for FMCG and consumer-facing clients across **Mexico** and the **US**, translating ambiguous market problems into phased plans with measurable growth directives.
- Direct a **6-person team** across consumer research, performance analysis, and omni-channel planning, setting diagnostic priorities and ensuring recommendation integrity before client presentation.
- Establish omni-channel performance strategy across traditional and digital marketing channels (OOH, print, **Google Ads**, **Meta**, **TikTok**, and **email**), holding accountability for media ROI, customer acquisition cost, and retention rates.
- Serve as senior client partner for C-level stakeholders, owning the strategic recommendations and their defense across pricing, messaging, channel mix, and portfolio sequencing.

Key Wins:

- Reduced **CAC** for a consumer brand through diagnosing a systematic problem, adjusted and performed an audience re-segmentation resulting in a robust communication funnel, and a **72%** reduction in acquisition cost.
- GTM strategy and portfolio restructuring drove **+15% YoY sales** for a functional hydration beverages client.
- A/B testing across paid social channels cut **CPC by 20%**, reallocating freed budget to higher-converting acquisition.
- **75%** client return rate across portfolio, reflecting consistent recommendation quality and commercial outcomes.

Grupo Mariposa - US Venture Lead.

Apr 2020 - Feb 2024

Food and Beverages FMCG | Mexico City, Mexico

- Set investment priorities for **US\$750K per-project** budgets with full operational authority and, as the P&L owner, defended every capital allocation decision before the board using phased OKRs, CAPEX, and EBITDA projections.
- Leading a matrixed **team of up to 10**, built and led Grupo Mariposa's **US venture** entry from zero, no prior market presence; with full accountability across consumer validation, NPD, supply chain, and first-year commercialization.
- Governed an innovation pipeline of **60+ annual SKUs**, defining the market strategy from scratch. The existing LATAM portfolio required full consumer-centric redevelopment for US consumers and better-for-you segments.
- Built the consumer-validation methodology from the ground up, screening **165+ innovation concepts** annually across **20 iterative validation** cycles per SKU across California, Texas, and New York markets.

Key Wins:

- Lead product from the consumer-validation pipeline contributed **35% of total US first-year revenue**, built entirely from category definition through commercialization in a market with no prior company presence.
- Digital-channel campaign achieved **3% CTR** across pipeline, validated through **GA4** and **Meta Business Suite**.

Health & Beauty CPG | Mexico City, Mexico

- Held regional P&L accountability for **Neutrogena**, **Listerine**, **Johnson's Baby**, **Lubriderm**, and **Tylenol** across **Mexico**, **Central America**, the **Caribbean**, and the **Andean region**, owning revenue growth, pricing strategy, and margin defense while balancing regional brand direction with language nuances in locally relevant commercial executions.
- Identified that the four-year regulatory stall was a stakeholder and timing alignment problem, and built a dedicated task force using PMO methodology to reverse-engineer, map, and execute the critical path to launch.
- Set innovation and NPD pipeline priorities for **LATAM** based on consumer insights, shopper marketing intelligence, and category segmentation, translating market data into evidence-based investment reflected in Brand Plans.
- Coached and developed a regional **team of 4** direct reports across Mexico, Colombia, and Panama.

Key Wins:

- Delivered **+11% YoY revenue growth** through innovation launches and shopper programs across 13 countries.
- Neutrogena Sun Care reached **9% category SOM** and generated **+10% incremental B2B** revenue within two years of launch, directly enabled by resolution of the four-year regulatory stall.
- Drove **2 talent promotions** and built the business case to create a new role strengthening team capabilities.
- Part of the **James E. Burke Award 2019** winning team, J&J's highest global marketing recognition.

PepsiCo - Marketing Innovation Manager.

Nov 2012 - Mar 2017

Food and Beverage FMCG | Mexico City, Mexico

- Governed the full innovation agenda for **Doritos**, **Cheetos**, **Tostitos**, and **Quaker**, managing development priorities and commercialization sequencing for **60+ SKUs** annually across four brands.
- Led **2 direct reports** and directed cross-functional alignment across Sales, Insights, Creative, Ops, Shopper and Trade Marketing in a fully matrixed structure, translating brand plans into channel-specific commercial execution.
- Held commercial accountability for innovation pipeline performance across four brands, owning revenue delivery against AOP targets through disciplined launch sequencing and trade channel execution.

Key Wins:

- Originated **Doritos Rainbow** by identifying an untapped revenue source, converting the insight into a project mandate; **SOLD OUT in one week**, generated **200M+ pieces** of organic user-generated content, grew **brand SOM by +2.3%**, and became an annual flagship campaign and cultural marketing benchmark.
- Recognized with two awards for **Doritos Rainbow: Circle of Champions**, PepsiCo's global marketing recognition, and the **President's Outliers Honor**, a local CEO recognition for outstanding leadership.

**EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS**

Tecnologico de Monterrey (ITESM)

- **Bachelor of Engineering degree in Information and Communications Technology**
 - Leadership Diploma

Project Management Institute PMI®

- **Project Management Professional®, PMP**

Scrum Alliance

- **CSPO™ Agile Methodology Product Owner**

Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania

- **Marketing Data Analysis**

Kellogg School of Management

- **Strategic Marketing**

**LANGUAGES**

- **Spanish** - Native
- **English** - Native
- **Portuguese** - Intermediate

**CORE SKILLS**

| Brand Strategy | Innovation & NPD
| P&L Management | GTM Execution
| Shopper Marketing | Digital Performance
| Consumer Insights | Team Leadership

**SOFTWARE**

- **Nielsen**
- **Euromonitor**
- **Kantar**
- **Google Analytics**
- **Google Ads**
- **Meta Business Suite**
- **SEMrush (SEO / SEM)**
- **HubSpot (CRM)**
- **Tableau (BI)**
- **Microsoft Office Suite**